were just no holes in the plan. Lt Gen Narasimhan could have watered down the plan, but he was too much of a professional to do so. Finally, the war game commenced in the presence of the Army Commander, Lt Gen Dalbir Singh Suhag.[3] The MGGS (Designate) of the Command, (then) Maj Gen Bipin Rawat, was also in attendance. I presented my plans and there was a short break thereafter to confer and decide on how to proceed. It became clear that Yellow Land had the mobilization deferential in their favour, and Blue Land (India) was at risk of defeat. Yellow Land had to be slowed down, but how? The Control conjured up a massive storm that made all the roads impassable and the airfields unfit for operations, thus delaying Yellow Land by forty-eight crucial hours, by which time Blue Land was able to move into their designated areas. The funny part though, was that it rained only on the Yellow Land side, 'the rain in Spain stays mainly in the plain'. I remonstrated with the Army Commander that this was not fair. Met conditions are known well in advance and if I had known of adverse weather conditions, I would have delayed the start of the operation by forty-eight hours. I pointed out that under similar conditions, Operation Overlord, the Allied invasion of Europe in WWII, had been postponed by twenty-four hours. To this, the Army Commander responded by saying, 'That was just a small-scale operation.' I could not believe my ears, and it took all my self-control not to smile. Blue Land won as usual, but in doing so, we did not learn the correct lessons. I was once again reminded of what President APJ Abdul Kalam had said, 'Don't read success stories, you will only get a message. Read failure stories, you will get some ideas to get success.'

A few months later was the Command War Game, which would be attended by the Chief, Gen Bikram Singh. For war games at the Command level, the functions of the 'enemy' are

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